

POSITION DESCRIPTION



Principal Engineer - AI

POSITION DESCRIPTION

WHERE THIS ROLE FITS IN

JOB TITLE	Principal Engineer
TYPE	<i>Permanent Full Time</i>
DEPARTMENT	Product & Engineering
REPORTS TO	Head of Engineering
DIRECT REPORTS	1 Engineer
LOCATION	Sydney
KEY RELATIONSHIPS	Exec team who sponsors the work
DATE	

ABOUT THE COMPANY

Compare Club provides comparison services across a broad range of household expense categories aimed at making it easier for consumers to make the right purchasing decisions, providing them more value and peace of mind. We have over 500 employees across Melbourne, Sydney, Brisbane and around the world. Everything we do is aimed at helping customers save money on household bills.



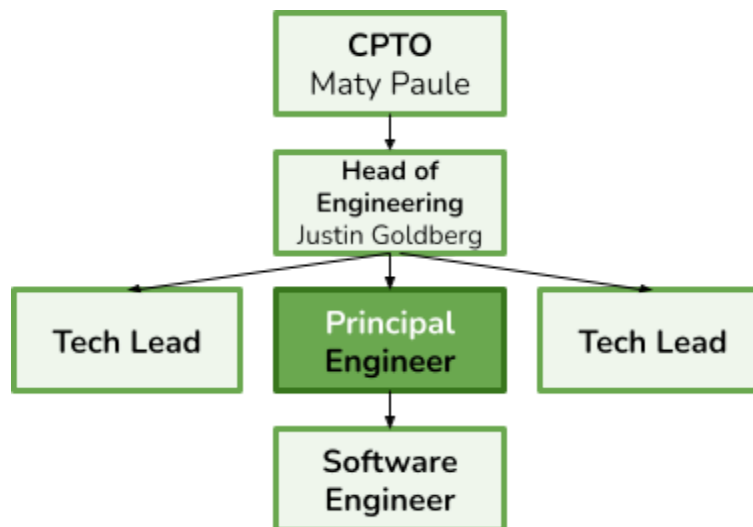
POSITION DESCRIPTION

COMPARE  CLUB

POSITION SUMMARY

A technical visionary passionate about building the next generation of intelligent applications. We are seeking a Principal Software Engineer to lead the design and development of our new AI-powered products. This is a pivotal, hands-on role where you will not just be a consumer of AI, but an architect of it. You will leverage your deep expertise in Python or JavaScript, modern web frameworks, and Agentic AI to build sophisticated, scalable applications from the ground up. Operating with a high degree of autonomy, you will set the technical strategy, mentor a talented team, and solve complex, ambiguous challenges that directly impact our customers. If you're a leader who thrives on turning cutting-edge AI services into tangible, market-leading products, we want to talk to you.

ORG CHART



POSITION DESCRIPTION



KEY ACCOUNTABILITIES AND OWNERSHIP ON BEHALF OF THE DIVISION

AI Product Architecture	Design, own, and evolve the end-to-end system architecture for our AI-driven products, ensuring scalability, resilience, and maintainability.
Technical Strategy & Innovation	Drive the technical vision for AI applications. Evaluate, prototype, and recommend new AI technologies, frameworks (e.g., LangChain), and third-party services (e.g., Vertex AI, ElevenLabs) to solve critical business problems.
Hands-On Development Leadership	Lead the development of core product features, writing clean, high-quality Python code. Champion best practices for building robust RESTful APIs using frameworks like FastAPI or Django.
Generative AI Implementation	Spearhead the practical application of Generative AI, LLMs, and RAG pipelines. Design and implement solutions leveraging vector databases and AI SDKs to create intelligent, responsive user experiences.
Mentorship & Team Elevation	Mentor and guide other engineers, fostering a culture of technical excellence, innovation, and continuous learning. Elevate the team's capabilities through code reviews, design discussions, and knowledge sharing.

KEY FUNCTIONS

System Design	Create and maintain comprehensive architecture and design documents for AI-powered systems.
Project Leadership	Lead complex technical projects from initial concept through to successful launch, navigating ambiguity and managing technical risks.
Code & Quality Evangelism	Set the standard for code quality, testing, and CI/CD practices within the AI product space
Stakeholder Communication	Effectively communicate complex technical concepts, strategies, and project status to both technical and non-technical stakeholders, including the executive team



POSITION DESCRIPTION



How Success will be Measured	The successful launch and adoption of innovative, high-quality AI-powered products and features. The performance, scalability, and reliability of the systems you design and build. Your demonstrated impact on the company's technical direction and strategy for AI. Growth and development of the engineers you mentor, evidenced by their increased autonomy and technical contributions.
What you bring to the role	● Passion for learning and improving: You may not have commercial AI experience but you tinker with it at home or on side projects and you push to use these technologies to solve real problems ● Principal-Level Engineering Experience: Extensive experience as a software engineer, with a proven track record in a technical leadership role (Principal, Staff, or Lead Engineer) within a modern tech environment ● Expertise in Python/JavaScript: Deep, hands-on expertise in Python or JavaScript building scalable, resilient modern web apps using FastAPI, Django, Node.js/Nest, or similar ● Applied AI Experience even outside of work: Demonstrable, hands-on experience building and shipping features powered by Generative AI, LLMs, and RAG pipelines. You are an "AI Application Developer," not a data scientist. ● AI Ecosystem Proficiency: Practical knowledge of different AI systems (e.g., OpenAI, Vertex AI, ElevenLabs) and frameworks (e.g., LangChain). ● Architectural Prowess: A strong command of system design and architectural patterns for building complex, distributed client-server applications. You can navigate trade-offs and make critical technical decisions with confidence. You value test automation. ● Leadership and Influence: A natural mentor and leader who can inspire and elevate a team. You have experience driving technical direction and operating with a high degree of autonomy to deliver on ambiguous, large-scale projects. You won't be the person being told what to do, but rather the person telling us what we should do.



POSITION DESCRIPTION

COMPARE  CLUB

- **Exceptional Communication:** The ability to articulate a technical vision clearly and concisely to engineers, product managers, and senior leadership incl. execs.

COMPANY VALUES

Be passionate about the customer and what we do	• <i>Love what you do.</i> • <i>Be positive, energetic and enthusiastic.</i> • <i>Have a “can do” attitude.</i>
Driven for results	• <i>Understand the goal.</i> • <i>Focus on the goal.</i> • <i>Adjust the plan if it is not achieving the goal.</i>
We are one team	• <i>We rise or fall as a team not individuals.</i> • <i>No one person has all the answers.</i> • <i>Don’t control access to information.</i> • <i>Be open and honest with one another.</i> • <i>Show respect – We all bring a new and differing perspective.</i>
Get it done	• <i>Done is better than perfect.</i> • <i>Be nimble, be decisive, be practical.</i> • <i>If you don’t know all the steps to achieve something, the best way to start is to take the first step.</i>
Have a crack	• <i>Challenge the Status Quo. Be inquisitive. Experiment and Innovate.</i> • <i>Take the Initiative.</i> • <i>Believe in yourself and your ideas – Don’t be afraid to give it a go.</i> • <i>The risk of not trying is greater than the risk of getting it wrong.</i>

VERSION CONTROL



Be passionate | Driven for results | Have a crack | Get it done | We are one team

POSITION DESCRIPTION

COMPARE  CLUB

Author	Version	Approver	Date



POSITION DESCRIPTION

COMPARE  CLUB

Capability Framework (Examples Only – Please refer to the Capability Framework for appropriate capabilities to the role!)

Capability Group	Capability Name	Description	Level
Personal Attributes	Display Resilience and Courage	Be open and honest, prepared to express your views, and willing to accept and commit to change.	Intermediate
	Act with Integrity	Be ethical and professional and uphold and promote the Compare Club Australia values.	Intermediate
	Manage Self	Show drive and motivation, an ability to self-reflect and a commitment to learning.	Intermediate
	Value Diversity & Inclusion	Demonstrate inclusive behaviour and show respect for diverse backgrounds, experiences, and perspectives.	Intermediate
Relationships	Communicate Effectively	Communicate clearly, actively listen to others, and respond with understanding and respect.	Adept
	Commit to Customer Service	Provide customer-focused services in line with CCA Strategy and organisational objectives.	Adept
	Work Collaboratively	Collaborate with others and value their contribution.	Adept
	Influence and Negotiate	Gain consensus and commitment from others and resolve issues and conflicts.	Adept
Results	Deliver Results	Achieve results through the efficient use of resources and a commitment to quality outcomes.	Adept
	Plan and Prioritise	Plan to achieve priority outcomes and respond flexibly to changing circumstances.	Intermediate
	Think and Solve Problems	Think, analyse, and consider the broader context to develop practical solutions.	Adept



POSITION DESCRIPTION

COMPARE  CLUB

	Demonstrate Accountability	Be proactive and responsible for own actions, and adhere to legislation, policy, and guidelines.	Adept
Technical / Professional	Training Analysis & Research	Identification and analysis of intricate learning needs.	Intermediate
	Training Design	Expertise in developing comprehensive training strategies.	Intermediate
	Training Development	Significant expertise in modern instructional design methods to inform development outcomes.	Intermediate
	Training Delivery	Proven ability to lead and inspire through advanced facilitation.	Adept
	Training Evaluation	Fine-tuned assessment of training effectiveness and strategic adaptation (individual and organisational).	Intermediate

